

Key features of Step Function:

- Concept of Step function is inspired by tasks and state machines.
- Step function comes with a visual display. Step Function Console shows the graphical view of your workflow. It makes the debugging process easier.
- State machines are defined using Amazon's own language called Amazon State language. It is nothing but a simple Json based language.

Some use cases of Step Function:

Any computational problem or business process can be divided in some steps. Step function help co-ordinate among those steps.

- You can use step function for data processing application where you need to unify data from multiple sources.
- Now in IT industry everyone is talking about automation. Everything should be automated. You can use step function to automate your software release process. It will help you in continuous and automatic deployment of your software.
- You can use Step Function for E-commerce where you need to automate critical business process.

Getting started with Step Function:

You need to follow the below steps to create a step function:

- First you need to create a lambda function and define IAM group.
- Then create Lambda State machine with this Lambda function and start a new execution.
- Now create a job status poller.
- Create a task timer and start state machine using CloudWatch event.
- Finally create a step function API.
- Your step function is ready to use.

We can conclude that AWS Lambda gives you the opportunity to run your application without providing a server or physical compute resources explicitly. You need not worry about server management, operating system maintenance, logging or monitoring your application. Just go and deploy your code. You can concentrate your efforts only in building a great and reliable application. Along with Lambda, Step Function gives you the provision of graphical visualisation of your application. You can also keep track of each and every step performed by your application. So, let's build cost effective serverless application! 